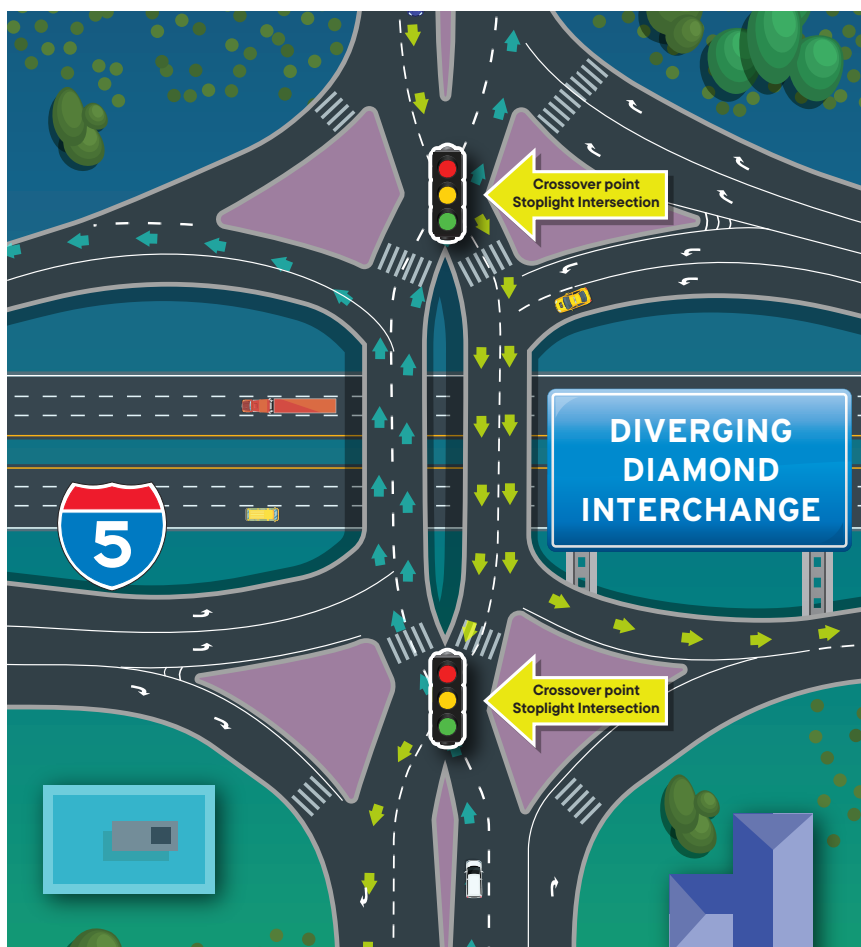




DIVERGING DIAMONDS

A diverging diamond is a new type of intersection in Washington. It's designed so traffic can cross to the other side of the roadway. This might not seem logical because you cross lanes with traffic going in the opposite direction. The intersection allows for vehicles to turn left (on and off freeway ramps) more efficiently. These intersections reduce the number of points where vehicles cross paths, which in turn decreases the risk of collisions. By eliminating left turns against oncoming traffic, diverging diamond intersections improve traffic flow and reduce congestion.